Hans Fredrik Sunde, PhD

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Updated 20 October 2026. Professional activities and teaching listed through June 2025, with selected later additions.

Education

- **PhD in Psychology**, University of Oslo, Oslo, Norway, 2024.
  - Sunde, H. F. (2024). *Reproduction of socioeconomic differences and mental health across generations* [Doctoral dissertation, University of Oslo]. Oslo, Norway. http://hdl.handle.net/10852/110758
  - Main Supervisor: Dr. Fartein Ask Torvik.
  - Co-Supervisor: Dr. Espen Moen Eilertsen.
- **MSc in Psychology**, Norwegian University of Science and Technology, Trondheim, Norway, 2019.
  - Supervisor: Dr. Robert Biegler.
- **BSc in Psychology**, Norwegian University of Science and Technology, Trondheim, Norway, 2017.

Positions Held

- **03.2025 – 03.2026:** Researcher (20%), Department of Psychology, University of Oslo, Oslo, Norway.
- **10.2023 – present:** Postdoctoral Researcher, Centre for Fertility and Health, Norwegian Institute of Public Health, Oslo, Norway.
- **05.2023 – 06.2023:** Researcher, Department of Special Needs Education, University of Oslo, Oslo, Norway.
- **08.2020 – 09.2023:** Doctoral Researcher, Centre for Fertility and Health, Norwegian Institute of Public Health, Oslo, Norway.
- **06.2019 – 06.2020:** Research Assistant, Department of Psychology, Norwegian University of Science and Technology, Trondheim, Norway.

Awards

- **2024:** Outstanding Associate Member Poster Presentation Award (formerly the Rowe Award), Behavior Genetics Association, London. Awarded annually for the best poster by a doctoral or other associate member; recognised my work on indirect assortative mating.
- **2023:** Outstanding Associate Member Oral Presentation Award (formerly the Thompson Award), Behavior Genetics Association, Murcia. Awarded annually for the best talk by a doctoral or other associate member; recognised my work on genetic evidence for assortative mating and increasing genetic variance across generations.

Publications

First- and last-author publications

Preprints

- Malawsky, D.S., Hegemann, L., Wootton, O., Havdahl, A.K., **Sunde, H.F.**, & Martin, H.C. (2026). Phantom genetic nurture: assortative mating accounts for most of the apparent association between parental genotypes and childhood cognitive performance. *bioRxiv*. [Preprint]. https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.09.01.748516 *Joint last author.*

Journal articles

- **Sunde, H.F.**, & Dierker, P. (2026). Are Spouses Similar in Divorce? Investigating Spousal Similarity in Couple-Shared Outcomes. *Twin Research and Human Genetics*. https://doi.org/10.1017/thg.2026.10050
- **Sunde, H.F.**, Eilertsen, E.M., Kinge, J.M., Kleppestø, T.H., Nordmo, M., Caspi, A., Moffitt, T.E., & Torvik, F.A. (2026). Parental income and psychiatric disorders from age 10 to 40: a genetically informative population study. *Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry*. https://doi.org/10.1111/jcpp.70022
- **Sunde, H.F.**, Eilertsen, E.M., & Torvik, F.A. (2025). Understanding indirect assortative mating and its intergenerational consequences for educational attainment. *Nature Communications*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-025-60483-0
- Skirbekk, V., Blekesaune, M., & **Sunde, H.F.** (2025). Personality and fertility dynamics in Norway across four decades – Findings from the HUNT survey. *Personality and Individual Differences*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2024.112862
- **Sunde, H.F.**, Eftedal, N.H., Cheesman, R., Corfield, E.C., Kleppestø, T.H., Seierstad, A.C., Ystrom, E., Eilertsen, E.M., & Torvik, F.A. (2024). Genetic similarity between relatives provides evidence on the presence and history of assortative mating. *Nature Communications*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-024-46939-9
- **Sunde, H.F.**, Kleppestø, T.H., Gustavson, K., Nordmo, M., Reme, B.-A., & Torvik, F.A. (2022). The ADHD deficit in school performance across sex and parental education: A prospective sibling-comparison register study of 344,152 Norwegian adolescents. *JCPP Advances*. https://doi.org/10.1002/jcv2.12064

Other co-authored publications

Preprints

- Bjørndal, L.D., Valstad, M., Ayorech, Z., Eilertsen, E.M., van Jole, O., **Sunde, H.F.**, Grande, T.J.M., Torvik, F.A., Kendler, K.S., & Ystrom, E. (2026). Family genetic risk scores for major psychiatric and neurodevelopmental diagnoses in the Norwegian population. *PsyArXiv*. [Preprint]. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/4qtu5_v2
- van Bergen, E., **Sunde, H.F.**, Rowland, C.F., Melby-Lervåg, M., & Torvik, F.A. (2025). Why educational inequality runs in families: Genetics matter more than environment. *PsyArXiv*. [Preprint]. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/rehdj_v1

Journal articles

- Aczel, B., et al. (2026). Investigating the analytical robustness of the social and behavioural sciences. *Nature*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-025-09844-9
- Andersen, M.L., **Sunde, H.F.**, Hart, R.K., & Torvik, F.A. (2026). Parenthood and mental health throughout the life course: A total population study. *Social Psychiatry and Psychiatric Epidemiology*. https://doi.org/10.1007/s00127-026-03091-7
- Andersen, M.L., Hart, R.K., **Sunde, H.F.**, Davies, N.M., & Torvik, F.A. (2026). The cost of caring: Gendered health and labor market effects of grandparenthood. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2535409123
- Reme, B.-A., **Sunde, H.F.**, Torvik, F.A., Kinge, J.M., Strand, B.H., & Wörn, J. (2026). Parental income in childhood and health outcomes across age groups: a register-based study from Norway. *BMC Medicine*. https://doi.org/10.1186/s12916-026-04735-w
- Landmark, L., **Sunde, H.F.**, Fors, E.A., Kennair, L.E.O., & Reme, S.E. (2026). Prevalence of Bodily Distress Syndrome and Prediction of Patient Outcomes: Cohort Study of 3762 Individuals With Persistent Pain. *European Journal of Pain*. https://doi.org/10.1002/ejp.70212
- Eilertsen, E.M., Eftedal, N.H., Cheesman, R., Ayorech, Z., Ebeltoft, J.C., **Sunde, H.F.**, Tandberg, A.D., Torvik, F.A., & Ystrom, E. (2026). Multivariate maternal effects across the internalizing–externalizing spectrum in

childhood: results from the Norwegian mother, father, and child cohort study. *Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry*. https://doi.org/10.1111/jcpp.70111

- Kleppestø, T.H., Bendixen, M., **Sunde, H.F.**, Zietsch, B., Harper, K.T., Karlsen, H., Stavang, M., Eftedal, N.H., & Kennair, L.E.O. (2026). The attractive personality: Like me, but better. *Evolution and Human Behavior*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.evolhumbehav.2025.106811
- Nordmo, M., **Sunde, H.F.**, Kleppestø, T.H., Nordmo, M., Caspi, A., Moffitt, T.E., & Torvik, F.A. (2025). Cognitive Abilities and Educational Attainment as Antecedents of Mental Disorders: A Total Population Study of Males. *Psychological Science*. https://doi.org/10.1177/09567976251347221
- Eftedal, N.H., Eilertsen, E.M., **Sunde, H.F.**, Kleppestø, T.H., Ystrom, E., & Czajkowski, N.O. (2025). Beyond additive genetic effects: Explaining family resemblance in school performance across millions of pairs of Norwegian relatives. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2419627122
- Torvik, F.A., **Sunde, H.F.**, Cheesman, R., Eftedal, N.H., Keller, M.C., Ystrom, E., & Eilertsen, E.M. (2024). Non-random mating patterns within and across education and mental and somatic health. *Nature Communications*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-024-54966-9
- Caspi, A., Houts, R.M., Moffitt, T.E., Richmond-Rakerd, L.S., Hanna, M.R., **Sunde, H.F.**, & Torvik, F.A. (2024). A nationwide analysis of 350 million patient encounters reveals a high volume of mental-health conditions in primary care. *Nature Mental Health*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s44220-024-00310-5
- Nordmo, M., Kleppestø, T.H., Reme, B.-A., **Sunde, H.F.**, von Soest, T., & Torvik, F.A. (2024). The diminishing association between adolescent mental disorders and educational performance from 2006–2019. *JCPP Advances*. https://doi.org/10.1002/jcv2.12239
- Landmark, L., **Sunde, H.F.**, Fors, E.A., Kennair, L.E.O., Sayadian, A., Backelin, C., & Reme, S.E. (2024). Associations between pain intensity, psychosocial factors, and pain-related disability in 4285 patients with chronic pain. *Scientific Reports*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-024-64059-8
- Kleppestø, T.H., Eilertsen, E.M., van Bergen, E., **Sunde, H.F.**, Zietsch, B., Nordmo, M., Eftedal, N.H., Havdahl, A., Ystrom, E., & Torvik, F.A. (2024). Intergenerational transmission of ADHD behaviors: genetic and environmental pathways. *Psychological Medicine*. https://doi.org/10.1017/S003329172300315X
- Nordmo, M., Kleppestø, T.H., **Sunde, H.F.**, Flatø, M., Demange, P., & Torvik, F.A. (2023). The association between parental internalizing disorders and child school performance. *npj Science of Learning*. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41539-023-00182-x
- Lisøy, R.S., Pfuhl, G., **Sunde, H.F.**, & Biegler, R. (2022). Sweet spot in music—Is predictability preferred among persons with psychotic-like experiences or autistic traits? *PLOS ONE*. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0275308

Professional activities

Research Stays

- **September – November 2024:** Complex Trait Genetics Lab, Center for Neurogenomics and Cognitive Research, VU Amsterdam (Host: Prof. Dr. Dorret Boomsma).

Workshops

- International Statistical Genetics Workshop 2024 (Boulder, CO).
- VU Amsterdam Summer School 2022: Nature and Nurture: Twin Research and Human Genetics.
- International Statistical Genetics Workshop 2021 (Online).

Conference presentations

- Sunde, H.F., (2026) Are spouses similar in divorce? Investigating spousal similarity in couple-shared outcomes. Behavior Genetics Association Annual Meeting (Amsterdam 2026). Oral presentation.
- Sunde, H.F., (2025) Is divorce a male or female trait? BIOSFER Conference: Fertility, Childlessness, and Reproductive Aging: Bio-social Perspectives (Villa Vigoni, Menaggio, 16 September 2025). Oral presentation.
- Sunde, H.F., (2025) Combining genetic and phenotypic data in extended families to investigate indirect assortative mating and gene-environment correlations. Behavior Genetics Association Annual Meeting (Atlanta 2025). Oral presentation.

- Sunde, H.F., (2025) Understanding indirect assortative mating and its intergenerational consequences. European Social Science Genetics Network (Bristol 2025). Oral presentation.
- Sunde, H.F., (2024) Rethinking partner similarity: Understanding indirect assortative mating and its consequences for educational attainment. Behavior Genetics Association Annual Meeting (London 2024). Poster presentation.
- Sunde, H.F., (2024) Rethinking indirect assortative mating. International Statistical Genetics Workshop (Boulder, CO 2024). Poster presentation.
- Sunde, H.F., (2024) Genetic similarity between relatives provides evidence on the presence and history of assortative mating. Human Behavior and Evolution Society (Aarhus 2024). Oral presentation.
- Sunde, H.F., (2023) Assortative mating increases genetic similarity among distant relatives: Evidence from polygenic scores. Behavior Genetics Association Annual Meeting (Murcia 2023). Oral presentation.
- Sunde, H.F., (2023) Parental income and mental disorders from age 10 to 35: a genetically informative population study. Norwegian Social and Community Psychology Conference (Trondheim 2023). Oral presentation.
- Sunde, H.F., (2022) Skoleforløp blant barn med ADHD. En prospektiv register-og søskenstudie av norske tenåringer. ADHD Forskningsnetverk NevSom (Trondheim 2022). Oral presentation.

Invited talks

2025

- **19/05/2025:** Phenome-wide analysis of half siblings suggests maternal effects on adult health are common. BIOSFER Scientific Seminars (Online).
- **15/05/2025:** Phenome-wide analysis of half siblings suggests maternal effects on adult health are common. 8th Annual CeFH Symposium (Oslo).
- **28/01/2025:** How to give better presentations: tips, tricks, and some guiding principles. CeFH Internal Seminar (Norefjell).
- **17/01/2025:** The theory crisis. CeFH Friday Seminar (Oslo).

2024

- **09/12/2024:** Å forstå indirekte assortativ pardannelse og dets intergenerasjonalle konsekvenser, Lab Meeting, Sexual Conflict Research Group (Trondheim).
- **09/12/2024:** Parental income and mental disorders from age 10 to 40, TTiT Lab Meeting (Trondheim).
- **20/11/2024:** Partnerlikhet og sosial ulikhet, REMENTA Sluttesminar (Oslo).
- **18/11/2024:** Understanding indirect assortative mating and its intergenerational consequences. FlaDD Lab Meeting (Nijmegen).
- **07/11/2024:** Understanding indirect assortative mating and its intergenerational consequences. GENE Amsterdam Research Meeting (Amsterdam).
- **24/09/2024:** Parental income and mental disorders from age 10 to 40: a genetically informative population study. BioPsy colloquium (Amsterdam).
- **11/09/2024:** Understanding indirect assortative mating and its intergenerational consequences. CNCR Seminar (Amsterdam).
- **29/08/2024:** Assortative mating: Genetics and partner selection. Genetics and Social Sciences Conference (Oslo).
- **14/06/2024:** ADHD og skoleprestasjoner. ADHD Norge fagråd (Oslo).
- **29/05/2024:** Understanding indirect assortative mating and its intergenerational consequences. BIOSFER workshop (Sandbjerg).
- **15/05/2024:** Understanding indirect assortative mating and its intergenerational consequences. 7th Annual CeFH Symposium (Oslo).
- **16/02/2024:** Genetic similarity between relatives provides evidence on the presence and history of assortative mating. PsychGen Friday Seminar (Oslo).

2023

- **06/12/2023:** Genetic similarity between relatives provides evidence on the presence and history of assortative mating. Social Science Genetics Seminar (Online).

- **01/12/2023:** Genetic similarity between relatives provides evidence on the presence and history of assortative mating. CeFH Genetics Friday (Oslo).
- **21/09/2023:** Genetic similarity between relatives provides evidence on the presence and history of assortative mating. BIOSFER workshop (Rostock).
- **12/05/2023:** ADHD and school performance. SpedAims Fagprat på Fredag (Oslo).
- **05/05/2023:** Assortative mating strongly increases genetic similarity between distant relatives. CeFH Genetics Friday (Oslo).
- **09/03/2023:** Kjønn, ADHD, og skoleprestasjoner. Health Gap Sluttseminar, Litteraturhuset (Oslo).
- **02/03/2023:** Correlation does not imply causation, even for genetics.... FHI Fagforum (Oslo).
- **15/05/2023:** Assortative mating strongly increases genetic similarity between distant relatives. 6th Annual CeFH Symposium (Oslo).

2022

- **18/11/2022:** Parental income and mental disorders: Using children-of-twins to distinguish genetic and social transmission. CeFH Genetics Friday (Oslo).
- **04/10/2022:** ADHD og karakterer i ungdomsskolen. ADHD Norge: Lærerkonferansen 2022 (Bergen).
- **27/09/2022:** ADHD and school performance across sex, parental education, and school subjects. ACAMH Around the Campfire (Online).
- **04/05/2022:** Mendelian Randomization: Symphony Orchestra or School Band? – Demonstrating breach of assumptions in IV analysis with simulations. CeFH Instrumental variable & Mendelian Randomization seminars (Oslo).
- **26/04/2022:** The Theory Crisis. Research Seminar: Personality, Genetics, and Mental Health (Oslo).
- **08/04/2022:** ADHD and school performance across sex, parental education, and school subjects. CeFH Friday Seminar (Oslo).

2021

- **16/12/2021:** Demonstrating common pitfalls with statistical control. PhD Network at NIPH Seminar (Oslo).
- **19/11/2021:** What is up with statistical control: When to use, when not to use, and when it's not enough. CeFH Friday Seminar (Oslo).
- **29/09/2021:** Are highly educated parents good for your mental health?. 4th Annual CeFH Symposium (Oslo).

Other activities

Co-organised the 2025 Oslo Conference on Social Science and Genetics (15th and 16th of June 2025).

Teaching Experience

Supervision

- **2024 – present:** Co-supervisor of a PhD candidate, Language Development Department, Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics, the Netherlands, with Caroline Rowland and Elsje van Bergen.
- **2026:** Co-supervisor of a master's student in psychology, University of Oslo, Norway.

Invited teaching

- **24–26 March 2026:** Invited lecturer, European Social Science Genetics Network methods workshop, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam. With Espen Eilertsen, taught two sessions: heritability and genetic correlations; and gene–environment correlation and assortative mating. Workshop and lecture slides.

External Examiner / Grader, miscellaneous clients

Miscellaneous lectures

Norwegian University of Science and Technology, Trondheim, Norway, 2020 – 2021.

- Introduction to Behavior Genetics, Personality Psychology 1, March 2020.
- The Replication Crisis, Research Design, March 2020.
- Statistical Power, Research Design, March 2020.
- The Replication Crisis and Statistical Power (3 lectures), Research Design, January-February 2021.

Teaching Assistant / Seminar Leader

Norwegian University of Science and Technology, Trondheim, Norway, 2018 – 2020.

- Weekly seminars, Quantitative Methods (master's level), Fall 2018.
- Weekly seminars, Quantitative Methods (master's level), Fall 2019.
- Full day seminar, Introduction to Stata (for employees), November 2019.
- Teaching assistant, Bachelor's project in developmental psychology, Spring 2020.

Media and public engagement

Popular science and commentary

- **2026:** Sunde, H.F., Pfuhl, G., Hernæs, Ø., & Korbmacher, M. Hva kjennetegner god vitenskap? *Forskersonen*, 13 April. Commentary.
- **2022:** Sunde, H.F. Din store familie. *Psykologisk tidsskrift*, 1, 44–49. Popular science article.

Podcasts and television

- **2026:** God Morgen Norge: interview about divorce. TV2, 10 April. Television interview.
- **2026:** Are your genes picking your partner? Hans Fredrik Sunde on all things assortative mating. *Born and Raised*, European Social Science Genetics Network, 18 March. Podcast guest.
- **2025:** LL-630: Hans Fredrik Sunde om skoleprestasjoner på tvers av generasjonene. *Lektor Lomsdalens innfall*, 4 March. Podcast guest.
- **2022:** LL-444: Livepodkast fra Lærerkonferansen 2022 om ADHD og skolen. *Lektor Lomsdalens innfall*, published 7 October. Panel participant.

Print and online interviews

- **2026:** Qui se Ressemble s'Assemble. *Epsiloon*, April. Interview on partner similarity (in French).
- **2026:** Ny forskning: De som har lik skilsmisserisiko, gifter seg ofte med hverandre. *Aftenposten*, 9 April.
- **2025:** Major study reshapes our understanding of assortative mating and its generational impact. *PsyPost*, 1 October.
- **2025:** 4.500 blind dates avslører at også kvinner foretrekker yngre partnere. *forskning.no*, 10 February.
- **2024:** Hvem folk velger å få barn med, er en viktig forklaring på ulikhet, ifølge forsker. *forskning.no*, 16 December.
- **2024:** Mor og far har mye til felles – og barna får dobbelt opp. *Dagens Medisin*.
- **2024:** Skoleprestasjoner hos barn med ADHD. *Magasinet Uro*, 19 September.
- **2022:** Forskning pyntes på for å bli publisert. *Under Dusken*, issue 1.